

Sunday, 21 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

30° 21°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

27° 16°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

25° 16°

GLASGOW

Overcast

22° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- Emergency services are still working at the scene of a deadly train crash near Bedford, with many people still in hospital.**

Nine people are in a critical condition out of a total of 28 still in hospital after the incident on Friday. Nearly 90 people were injured in total, with over 30 seriously hurt.

ACCIDENT · UK

- Police in Edinburgh are investigating a series of suspected anti-Muslim attacks, after five people were injured.**

An armed man was seen roaming the streets, injuring two people near a mosque and later battering the door of a pizzeria. Members of the public were seen running away.

CRIME · UK

- A man mistakenly prescribed morphine died two days later from an overdose, an inquest has heard.**

His widow described the incorrect prescription as like "a loaded gun". The case highlights serious concerns about prescription errors within the health service.

HEALTH · UK

- The Scottish Conservatives have hailed a historic by-election win in Aberdeen South, taking the seat from the SNP.**

This marks the party's first by-election win in Scotland since 1973. Kemi Badenoch said the result sends a clear message to both Labour and the SNP.

POLITICS · UK

- A rapist who 'catfished' Muslim men on social media has been jailed, with police believing there are dozens more victims.**

Waleed Saeed used Snapchat and Grindr to target his victims. Police are now appealing for anyone else who may have been affected to come forward.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 **Kim Kardashian's hair stylist, Chris Appleton, is swapping Hollywood for the ballroom, joining the Strictly Come Dancing line-up.**

The British stylist has worked with a host of A-list stars including Jennifer Lopez, Katy Perry, and Ariana Grande. He's known for creating some of the most iconic celebrity looks.

ON AIR – What kind of moves do you think a top stylist will bring to the dancefloor?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Singer Jack Savoretti has opened up about 'leaning into a midlife crisis' as he celebrates 20 years in music.**

He reflected on his long career and how moving to Oxfordshire helped shape his recent music. Savoretti is known for his soulful voice and acoustic sound.

ON AIR – Have you ever felt like a big life change helped you find new inspiration?

MUSIC · NOW

3 **Lil Nas X says he's 'feeling better' after a stint in rehab and a bipolar diagnosis.**

The 'Old Town Road' star was arrested last year for attacking police officers, which led to him seeking help. He's now focusing on his well-being and music.

ON AIR – It's good to hear artists openly talking about their mental health, isn't it?

MUSIC · NOW

4 **A UK rapper has thanked Linkin Park for 'changing my life' after Mike Shinoda gave her a freestyle shoutout.**

Megan Da Savage's rap was spotted by Shinoda on an independent music platform, leading to the unexpected recognition. It's a huge moment for the rising artist.

ON AIR – Isn't it amazing how a shoutout from a big star can change everything for a new talent?

MUSIC · NOW

5 **Toy Story 5 is dividing critics, but most are praising its 'cautionary' message about technology.**

The fifth instalment of the beloved animated franchise sees Tom Hanks, Tim Allen, and Joan Cusack return to voice their iconic characters. Fans are eager to see what new adventures await Woody and Buzz.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Toy Story film, and are you excited for this new one?

FILM · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 Northampton Saints have clinched the Premiership Rugby title, beating Exeter Chiefs in a thrilling final.

George Hendy was the hero for Northampton, scoring two crucial tries at Allianz Stadium. It's a fantastic achievement for the Saints, securing their place at the top.

ON AIR – What a win for Northampton! Do you think this signals a new era for them in Premiership Rugby?
RUGBY · UK

2 Ben Stokes has hit 95 for Durham, while the England national side appears to be struggling in their Test match.

The dropped England captain showed his class with a strong performance against Northamptonshire. Meanwhile, England are seemingly slipping towards defeat against New Zealand in the second Test.

ON AIR – Does Stokes' form for Durham make you think he should be back in the England squad immediately?
CRICKET · UK

3 Paraguay's Miguel Almiron became the first player to be sent off under new World Cup rules for covering his mouth.

The incident happened during Paraguay's win over Turkey, which saw them knock their opponents out of the 2026 World Cup. The new rules are certainly making an impact.

ON AIR – What do you make of these new rules preventing players from covering their mouths? Is it a good change?
FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP

4 Argentina's Francisco Cerundolo has reached the Queen's Club Championships final after beating Brandon Nakashima.

Cerundolo fought back after losing the first set to win 6-7(5), 6-3, 6-4. He'll now be looking to claim the prestigious title on grass.

ON AIR – Who are you backing in the Queen's final? Is this a sign of things to come at Wimbledon?
TENNIS · UK

5 Wyndham Clark holds a four-shot halfway lead at the US Open, with England's Matt Fitzpatrick among the chasing pack.

The wind has been hindering many of the top contenders, including Rory McIlroy and Scottie Scheffler. Clark is looking strong as he heads into the weekend.

ON AIR – Can anyone catch Wyndham Clark, or is the US Open already his to lose?
GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 Gardeners are increasingly turning to 'no-dig' methods to cultivate healthier soil and happier plants.**
This gentle approach to gardening involves adding organic matter to the surface rather than turning the soil, which helps preserve its structure and beneficial microbes. It's becoming a popular choice for both seasoned and new green thumbs.
- 2 There's a growing trend for 'slow travel', encouraging holidaymakers to immerse themselves more deeply in local culture.**
Instead of rushing from one landmark to another, slow travel advocates staying longer in one place, exploring its hidden gems, and connecting with the community. It's about savouring the journey as much as the destination.
- 3 A recent study suggests that listening to 'nature sounds' can significantly reduce stress and improve relaxation.**
Whether it's the gentle patter of rain or the calming chirping of birds, researchers found that these auditory experiences can lower cortisol levels and promote a sense of well-being. Time to put on those forest soundscapes!
- 4 The popularity of 'retro gaming' is soaring, with more people rediscovering classic video games from decades past.**
From arcade classics to early console gems, enthusiasts are enjoying the nostalgia and simpler gameplay of yesteryear. It's a delightful trip down memory lane for many, and a new discovery for younger generations.
- 5 Experts are noting a rise in 'mindful eating', where individuals pay closer attention to their food and eating experience.**
This practice involves slowing down, savouring each bite, and recognising hunger and fullness cues. It's not just about what you eat, but how you eat it, leading to a more satisfying relationship with food.
- 6 There's a renewed interest in 'letter writing', as people seek a more personal and thoughtful way to communicate.**
In an age of instant messages, the slower pace and tangible nature of a handwritten letter offer a unique charm. Receiving a personal note in the post can be a truly special moment.
- 7 The trend for 'micro-adventures' is gaining momentum, encouraging short, local escapades to boost well-being.**
These are brief, accessible adventures that don't require extensive planning or travel, like a night camping in your garden or a long walk in a nearby nature reserve. It's about finding adventure close to home.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our socks after washing them, even though we know it's probably not the best idea?

ANSWER: NOT PAIRING THEM UP IMMEDIATELY, AND JUST THROWING THEM INTO A 'SINGLE SOCK' DRAWER TO DEAL WITH LATER!

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a specific 'snack' that we only ever eat when no one else is around. What is it?

ANSWER: THAT SLIGHTLY ODD, PERHAPS 'GUILTY PLEASURE' SNACK THAT YOU JUST DON'T WANT TO SHARE OR EXPLAIN!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'smell' can instantly transport you back to a specific memory or a moment in time?**

Whether it's freshly cut grass taking you back to childhood summers, or the scent of a certain perfume reminding you of a loved one. What's that scent for you, and where does it take you?

- **We all have those little 'soundtrack moments' in life, don't we? Where a particular piece of music just perfectly fits the moment you're in.**

Perhaps it's a song that always makes a car journey feel epic, or a tune that brings sunshine to a rainy day. What's a song that perfectly accompanies one of your everyday moments?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a parliament?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The chameleon changes its colour not just to blend in, but also to regulate its body temperature by absorbing or reflecting heat.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£42 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£42 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible from outer space.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Hawaii is the only U.S. state that grows coffee.
- A 'tsundoku' is a Japanese term for the act of buying books and letting them pile up unread.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to the expansion of the iron from the heat.
- Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

On this day

Day 172 of the year, 193 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alban of Mainz; Christian feast day: Aloysius Gonzaga; Christian feast day: Engelmund of Velsen; Christian feast day: John Rigby. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1985 — Kris Allen, American musician, singer and songwriter
- 1964 — Dean Saunders, Welsh footballer and manager
- 1944 — Ray Davies, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1951 — Alan Hudson, English footballer
- 1964 — Doug Savant, American actor
- 1970 — Eric Reed, American pianist and composer
- 1992 — MAX, American singer, songwriter, actor, dancer and model
- 1947 — Michael Gross, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 2006 — Pluto's newly discovered moons are officially named Nix and Hydra.
- 1964 — Three civil rights workers, Andrew Goodman, James Chaney and Michael Schwerner, are murdered in Neshoba County, Mississippi, United States, by members of the Ku Klux Klan.
- 1970 — Penn Central declares Section 77 bankruptcy in what was the largest U.S. corporate bankruptcy to date.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1978 — The original production of Tim Rice and Andrew Lloyd Webber's musical, Evita, based on the life of Eva Perón, opens at the Prince Edward Theatre, London.
- 1942 — World War II: Tobruk falls to Italian and German forces; 33,000 Allied troops are taken prisoner.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2000 — Section 28 (of the Local Government Act 1988), outlawing the 'promotion' of homosexuality in the United Kingdom, is repealed in Scotland with a 99 to 17 vote.
- 1973 — In its decision in Miller v. California, 413 U.S. 15, the Supreme Court of the United States establishes the Miller test for determining whether something is obscene and not protected speech under the U.S. constitution.

- 2025 — A hot air balloon catches fire mid-flight and crashes in Praia Grande, Santa Catarina, Brazil, killing 8 of the 21 on board.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 173 of the year, 192 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron of Aleth; Christian feast day: Alban, first recorded Martyr in Britain (commemoration, Anglicanism); Christian feast day: Blessed Pope Innocent V; Christian feast day: Eusebius of Samosata (Catholic and Eastern Orthodox Church). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1974 — Donald Faison, American actor
- 1954 — Freddie Prinze, American comedian and actor (died 1977)
- 1961 — Jimmy Somerville, Scottish singer-songwriter
- 1940 — Esther Rantzen, English journalist
- 1992 — Harry Reid, British actor
- 1949 — Lindsay Wagner, American actress
- 1950 — Tom Alter, Indian actor (died 2017)
- 1950 — Sharon Maughan, English actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1942 — World War II: Erwin Rommel is promoted to Field Marshal after the Axis capture of Tobruk.
- 2025 — The United States conducts airstrikes on three Iranian nuclear sites in Fordow, Natanz, and Isfahan.
- 2012 — Paraguayan President Fernando Lugo is removed from office by impeachment and succeeded by Federico Franco.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1969 — The Cuyahoga River catches fire in Cleveland, Ohio, drawing national attention to water pollution, and spurring the passing of the Clean Water Act and the creation of the Environmental Protection Agency.
- 1948 — The ship HMT Empire Windrush brought the first group of 802 West Indian immigrants to Tilbury, marking the start of modern immigration to the United Kingdom.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)